

was all of 25 years old; the last thing I was concerned about was depleting my retirement assets.

I incorporated TransTech in February 1990 while continuing to work at Tellabs. I took ½ days off as vacation time whenever I had client sales calls. I used to work on the business at home in the morning from 6:30 AM to 8:30 AM, be at work during the day and again work on the business in the evening from 6:00 PM to midnight. I had a paycheck coming in and very little in the way of business expenses. When I had the first client and revenues over \$200,000 a year in the bag, I resigned.

If you look at the approach taken, it was a zero risk approach. The only downside I had was the possible loss of my paltry \$30,000 in 401(k) assets. The upside was enormous—easily several million dollars. Visa and MasterCard were my venture capitalists funding the rest of it. I was single at the time. There was no family to worry about. Many lunches and dinners back then were comprised of a simple Subway sandwich. My expenses were pretty low.

I considered staying at Tellabs to be a risky proposition. I thought that if I just stayed at the company, it was likely to be a boring and slow corporate path. If I woke up when I was 35 or 45 and decided to go off on my own, it would be much more complicated. I would likely have a wife and kids by then, which would make it harder to break loose and make a risk-free bet. Being 25 and single, I had available at least one risk-free bet.

My game plan was very simple. I had an arbitrage-based business model. The value proposition was leveraging India's deep expertise and available talent in client-server computing to satisfy the deep shortage of talent in the Midwestern United States. I had \$100,000 of capital available to me, and the business was already producing revenue and some profit when I resigned from Tellabs. I knew that with the first two customers on board, generating real revenue and profits, the downside was very limited. It was classic "Heads, I win; tails, I don't lose much."

TransTech scaled nicely. In 1996, we were recognized as an *Inc.* 500 company—one of the 500 fastest growing businesses in the United States. As revenues went from nothing to over \$20 million annually in 10 years,